

On Hittite Dictionaries

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1§. The Hittite language has a huge lexicological tradition, despite its "young age". For over a hundred years, since the first glossaries and dictionaries were published, the lexicological tradition of Hittitologists has been very strong, complex, and vivid, and it usually requires a great deal of time and attention to understand and comprehend.

In 1915, **Bedřich Hrozný** deciphered the Hittite language and demonstrated and proofed its Indo-European affiliation. His article *Die Lösung des hethitischen Problems* was followed by the grammar *Die Sprache der Hethiter, ihr Bau und ihre Zugehörigkeit zum indogermanischen Sprachstamm* in 1917 and by *Hethitische Keilschrifttexte aus Boghazköi, in Umschrift, mit Übersetzung und Kommentar* in 1919.

2§. The earliest substantial general lexical work was Edgar Howard Sturtevant's *A Hittite Glossary* (**HG**), first published in 1931 and substantially expanded in its second edition of 1936. A further supplement appeared in 1939. Sturtevant also published *A Comparative Grammar of the Hittite Language* in 1933 and, together with George Bechtel, *A Hittite Chrestomathy* in 1935. This stage did not yet constitute a fully-fledged, comprehensive dictionary, but it established a working lexicographical foundation for the fledgling discipline.

3§. The first full and proper dictionaries appeared only after the Second World War, but they were intended to be published before the war. The **Johannes Friedrich**'s *Hethitisches Wörterbuch* (**HW**), was published in 1954, years after his *Hethitisches Elementarbuch I-II*. The dictionary was a single-volume-work, yet it was the first comprehensive general dictionary of Hittite.

Later, his dictionary was expanded by him personally with three addenda *Ergänzungshefte*, in the years 1957, 1961, and 1966. The **HW** and *Ergänzungshefte* were combined and published together in 1991 in one book under the name *Kurzgefasstes Hethitisches Wörterbuch* (**KHW**).

4§. After Friedrich's death in year 1972, his student, Annelies Kammenhuber, who worked in Hittite Lexicology for a long time (ex. *Materialien zu einem Hethitischen Thesaurus*, started a new series of Hittite dictionaries known as the *Hethitisches Wörterbuch* (**HW²**)

In contrast to the conciseness of Friedrich's HW, Kammenhuber's HW² features extensive contextual information, translations, paradigms, a bibliography and a significant etymological component.

Since 1975, when the first instalments *Lieferungen* of the major Munich-LMU-based *Hethitisches Wörterbuch* (**HW²**) were published, this dictionary has been progressing roughly from the "beginning of the alphabet" towards the "middle".

To date, as part of this large-scale undertaking, volumes covering the lexical entries beginning with the letters A (Volume I), E (Volume II), 𐎶 (Volume III, in two parts) and I (Volume IV) have been published in full.

A working group, including hittitologists like Paola Cotticelli Kurras, Albertine Hagenbuchner-Dresel, Joost Hazenbos and Walther Sallaberger, at the Institute of Assyriology and Hittitology at the University of Munich is currently working on the fifth volume (Band V), which is devoted to the letter K: Issues 26 to 29, covering entries up to the lemma *kipriti*, have already been published, whilst the final issues 30–32, intended to complete the coverage of this letter, are currently in preparation and remain a work in progress.

The completion of the publication of the remaining instalments for the letter K is the planned final objective of the current phase of the development, as it is only after the publication of these instalments that the final lexicographical "alignment" of the Munich dictionary with the Chicago Hittite Dictionary (CHD), which historically began with the letter L, will be achieved.

5§. At the same time (1975), an endeavour was launched in Chicago, involving the Institute for the Study of Ancient Cultures (ISAC), also known as the Oriental Institute, under the direction of Hans Gustav Güterbock and Harry A. Hoffner Jr., later Theo P. J. van den Hout and Petra M. Goedegebuure, to publish the English-language, multi-volume *The Hittite Dictionary of the Institute for the Study of Ancient Cultures of the University of Chicago* (**CHD**).

The Chicago team's most significant structural decision was to avoid duplicating the Munich HW², which had begun work in parallel from the first letter of the alphabet, in order to avoid overlaps and cover the material as comprehensively and quickly as possible, the CHD began publication 'from the middle

to the end', starting with the letter L. It was precisely this approach that laid the foundation for his decision established a complementary division of labour between the Munich and Chicago dictionary projects.

The dictionary is being published as a long-term initiative through the release of individual fascicles, which are subsequently bound into volumes. To date, three large lexical ranges:

L–N, have been published in full: these were published in four instalments between 1980 and 1989, and a single consolidated volume was published in 1989.

P: these were published in three instalments between 1994 and 1997, and the consolidated volume was published in 1997.

S/Š: publication of this section began in 2002 and required four instalments, the last of which was published in 2019 together with the consolidated volume.

6§. In 2004, the Chicago Dictionary entered the digital age with the launch of its *electronic* version (**eCHD**) based on the **OCHRE** platform. The first volume to be digitised was the one beginning with the letter P. A distinctive feature of the eCHD is that Turkish meanings have been added to the original English dictionary entries, thereby expanding the dictionary's functionality. However, compared with its print version, the electronic application is still different from the "paper" CHD.

7§. An important addition to the Chicago Dictionary has been the Chicago Hittite Dictionary Supplements (**CHDS**) series, which has been published since 2011. This series publishes textual materials and lexical indices, with new lexical evidence and text editions. Edited by scholars as Oğuz Soysal, Rukiye Akdoğan and others, it features transliterations of previously unpublished fragments from Boğazköy (*Bo-Fragments*). The series currently comprises six volumes, published between 2011 and 2026. The sixth volume, by Oğuz Soysal and Mine Çifçi, appeared in 2026.

8§. Another important and extensive English-language dictionary series is Jaan Puhvel's *Hittite Etymological Dictionary* (**HED**), which constitutes an etymological thesaurus intended primarily for in-depth study of etymological issues and for Indo-European Studies. Affiliated with the University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA), it is published by Mouton / De Gruyter as part of the Trends in Linguistics. Documentation series.

Publication of the dictionary began in 1984 with a combined Volume 1 and 2, covering entries beginning with the letters A, E and I. In the decades that followed, the dictionary, which remains unfinished to this day, progressed systematically through the alphabet: volumes covering the letters Ĥ (Volume 3, 1991), K (Volume 4, 1997), L (Volume 5, 2001), M (Volume 6, 2004), N (Volume 7, 2007), PA (Volume 8, 2011), PE/PI/PU (Volume 9, 2013), "sibilants" SA (Volume 10, 2017) and SE/SI/SU (Volume 11, 2021).

An important structural milestone in the development of the dictionary was the publication of the fifth volume in 2001, as it included indexes for the first five parts, thereby providing researchers with convenient access to a comparative analysis of previously published material.

9§. The *Hethitisches etymologisches Glossar* (**HEG**) was compiled by Johann Tischler, with contributions by Günter Neumann and Erich Neu. Published between 1977 and 2016, it comprises sixteen *Lieferungen* organised into four parts and covers the alphabet from A to Z.

10§. Among Tischler's other (hand, compact) dictionaries, likewise published in a single volume, mention may be made of the *Vocabulaire hittite y compris louvite, palaïte, akkadien et sumérien*, co-authored with Sylvie Vanséveren, as well as the *Hethitisch-deutsches Wörterverzeichnis. Mit einem semasiologischen Index* (**HDtW**, 1982) und *Hethitisches Handwörterbuch. Mit dem Wortschatz der Nachbarsprachen* (**HHw**, 2001, 2008).

11§. *Hittite Vocabulary: An Anatolian Appendix to Buck's Dictionary of Selected Synonyms in the Principal Indo-European Languages* (**HV-AA**, 1985) by David Michael Weeks is organised as an onomasiological, semantically distributed lexical reference work.

12§. The *Multilinguales Handwörterbuch des Hethitischen* (**CMHD**), compiled by Ahmet Ünal and published in 2007, is a two-volume practical non-etymological dictionary providing German, English, and Turkish meanings and lots of Hittite verbs conjugations and nouns and pronouns declinations.

13§. Alwin Kloekhorst's *Etymological Dictionary of the Hittite Inherited Lexicon* (**EDHIL**) is a single-volume etymological study of the inherited component of the Hittite lexicon, published by Brill in 2008.

14§. The only up-to-date sign list for Hittite is the *Hethitisches Zeichenlexikon. Inventar und Interpretationen der Keilschriftzeichen aus den Boğazköy-Texten* (**HZL**, 1989, 2011), with two supplements: *Deutsch-Sumerographisches Wörterverzeichnis* 1991 and *Konträrindex der hethitischen Keilschriftzeichen* 1993. This work brought to completion the cataloguing of Hittite cuneiform signs initiated in the earlier studies of Bedřich Hrozný and Emil Forrer, particularly *Die Keilschrift Boghazköi* (1922).

15§. An important study for understanding the use of Sumerograms and their Hittite readings, as well as important "auxiliary Hittite lexicological monograph" is Mark Weeden's *Hittite Logograms and Hittite Scholarship* (**HLHS**, 2011). The work is of particular significance for the reconstruction of Hittite lexical items.

16§. One of the auxiliary reference works is Jin Jie's *A Complete Retro-*

grade Glossary of the Hittite Language (**CRGH**), published in 1994.

17§. **Laman** is a digital database of Hittite personal, divine, and geographical names. It provides normalised forms, variant spellings, textual attestations, and links to digital editions, making it an important resource for Hittite lexicography and onomastics.

18§. **TLH^{dig}** (*Thesaurus Linguarum Hethaeorum digitalis*) is an open-access repository of searchable and annotated transliterations of texts from the Hittite cuneiform archives. Although not a dictionary proper, it provides essential glossary, and corpus evidence for Hittite lexicographical and philological research. Its XML dataset (Beta Version 0.3) is also archived on **Zenodo**.

19§. **eDiAna** (*Digital Philological-Etymological Dictionary of the Minor Anatolian Corpus Languages*) is a digital dictionary of the lesser-attested ancient Anatolian languages, and also appeals to Hittite for etymological comparison, providing philological documentation, corpus attestations, and Anatolian and Indo-European etymologies. Its principal editors are Olav Hackstein, Jared Miller, Elisabeth Rieken, and Ilya Yakubovich.

20§. As stated at the beginning of this survey, Hittite possesses a substantial lexicographical and lexicological tradition, which continues to develop vigorously. One of the most important objectives of current research is the further digitisation of Hittite lexical resources. Comparable digital infrastructures have already been developed for Sumerian, most notably the *electronic Pennsylvania Sumerian Dictionary* (**ePSD2**), and for Akkadian through the digitised *Chicago Assyrian Dictionary* (**CAD**), as well as the *electronic Babylonian Literature Dictionary* (**eBL Dictionary**). The development of similarly integrated digital resources for Hittite would make lexical material more accessible, searchable, and suitable for systematic philological, linguistic, and quantitative analysis.

One particularly promising direction is the preparation of thematic lexicographical studies devoted to the semantic fields, lexical domains, and culturally significant groups of words. Such studies can complement traditional alphabetically organised dictionaries by revealing semantic relationships, patterns of usage, genre-specific distributions, and processes of historical change within the Hittite lexicon.

An equally important objective, repeatedly emphasised by **H. Craig Melchert**, is the systematic investigation of the lesser-attested Anatolian languages, both in their own right and in comparison with Hittite. Despite the fragmentary character of their corpora, languages such as Luwian, Palaic et.c. preserve indispensable evidence for the reconstruction of Proto-Anatolian and for a fuller understanding of the historical position of Hittite within the Anatolian branch.

Table 1: Published coverage of the principal multivolume Hittite dictionaries by initial letter

Initial	HW ²	CHD	HED	HEG
A	Bd. I 1975–1984	—	Vol. 1 1984	Teil I, Lfg. 1–4 1977–1983
E	Bd. II 1988	—	Vol. 2 1984	Teil I, Lfg. 1–4 1977–1983
Ḫ	Bd. III/1–2 1991–2013	—	Vol. 3 1991	Teil I, Lfg. 1–4 1977–1983
I	Bd. IV 2014–2017	—	Vol. 2 1984	Teil I, Lfg. 1–4 1977–1983
K	Bd. V, Lfg. 26–29 2017–2022 ^a	—	Vol. 4 1997	Teil I, Lfg. 1–4 1977–1983
L	—	Vol. L–N, fasc. 1–4 1980–1989	Vol. 5 2001	Lfg. 5–6 1990
M	—	Vol. L–N, fasc. 1–4 1980–1989	Vol. 6 2004	Lfg. 5–6 1990
N	—	Vol. L–N, fasc. 1–4 1980–1989	Vol. 7 2007	Lfg. 7 1991
P	—	Vol. P, fasc. 1–3 1994–1997	Vols. 8–9 2011, 2013	Lfg. 11/12 2001
Š	—	Vol. S/Š, fasc. 1–4 2002–2019	Vols. 10–11 2017, 2021	Lfg. 13–14 2004–2006
T	—	—	—	Teil III, Lfg. 8–10 T/D/1–3, 1991–1994
U	—	—	—	Lfg. 15 2010
W	—	—	—	Lfg. 16, W–Z 2016
Z	—	—	—	Lfg. 16, W–Z 2016

An em dash indicates that no volume covering the relevant initial has yet been published.

^a *Lieferung* 29 bears the publication year 2021 but appeared in 2022. Lieferungen 30–32 remain in preparation.

The "dental section" of the **HEG** is entitled T and D.

The **CHD** conventionally designates its published sibilant volume as **S**, although it covers entries conventionally transliterated with S.

Table 2: Chronology of major publications and projects in Hittite lexicography

1915	Bedřich Hrozný, <i>Die Lösung des hethitischen Problems</i> . The article demonstrated the Indo-European affiliation of Hittite and established the basis for its decipherment.
1917	Hrozný, <i>Die Sprache der Hethiter, ihr Bau und ihre Zugehörigkeit zum indogermanischen Sprachstamm</i> .
1919	Hrozný, <i>Hethitische Keilschrifttexte aus Boghazköi, in Umschrift, mit Übersetzung und Kommentar</i> .
1922	Emil Forrer, <i>Die Keilschrift Boghazköi</i> , an early systematic treatment of the cuneiform signs used in the Boğazköy texts.
1931	Edgar H. Sturtevant, <i>A Hittite Glossary (HG)</i> , first edition.
1933	Sturtevant, <i>A Comparative Grammar of the Hittite Language</i> .
1935	Edgar H. Sturtevant and George Bechtel, <i>A Hittite Chrestomathy</i> .
1936	Sturtevant, <i>A Hittite Glossary</i> , substantially enlarged second edition.
1939	Sturtevant, <i>Supplement to a Hittite Glossary, Second Edition</i> .
1940	Johannes Friedrich, <i>Hethitisches Elementarbuch</i> , Part I: <i>Kurzgefasste Grammatik</i> .
1946	Friedrich, <i>Hethitisches Elementarbuch</i> , Part II: <i>Lesestücke in Transkription, mit Erläuterungen und Wörterverzeichnissen</i> .
1952–1954	Friedrich, <i>Hethitisches Wörterbuch. Kurzgefasste kritische Sammlung der Deutungen hethitischer Wörter (HW)</i> . The dictionary began appearing in 1952 and was completed in 1954.
1957	Friedrich, first <i>Ergänzungsheft</i> to the HW .
1961	Friedrich, second <i>Ergänzungsheft</i> to the HW .
1966	Friedrich, third <i>Ergänzungsheft</i> to the HW .
1973–1988	Annelies Kammenhuber, <i>Materialien zu einem hethitischen Thesaurus</i> , Lieferungen 1–11. The series presented detailed lexical studies that were closely connected with the preparation of the new Munich dictionary.

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1975	Publication begins of <i>Hethitisches Wörterbuch. Zweite, völlig neubearbeitete Auflage auf der Grundlage der edierten hethitischen Texte (HW²)</i> , edited initially by Johannes Friedrich and Annelies Kammenhuber.
1977–1983	The Chicago Hittite Dictionary Project (CHD) is established at the University of Chicago. Johann Tischler, <i>Hethitisches etymologisches Glossar (HEG)</i> , Lieferungen 1–4, covering A–K.
1980	CHD , L–N, fascicle 1: <i>la-</i> to <i>ma-</i> .
1982	Johann Tischler, <i>Hethitisch-deutsches Wörterverzeichnis. Mit einem semasiologischen Index (HDtW)</i> .
1983	CHD , L–N, fascicle 2: <i>-ma</i> to <i>miyaḫuwant-</i> .
1984	HW² , Band I, A, Lieferungen 1–8, completed. Jaan Puhvel, <i>Hittite Etymological Dictionary (HED)</i> , vols. 1–2: <i>Words beginning with A</i> and <i>Words beginning with E and I</i> .
1985	David Michael Weeks, <i>Hittite Vocabulary: An Anatolian Appendix to Buck's Dictionary of Selected Synonyms in the Principal Indo-European Languages (HV-AA)</i> .
1986	CHD , L–N, fascicle 3: <i>miyaḫuwant-</i> to <i>nai-</i> .
1988	HW² , Band II, E, Lieferungen 9–10. Kammenhuber, <i>Materialien zu einem hethitischen Thesaurus</i> , Lieferung 11.
1989	CHD , L–N, fascicle 4: <i>nai-</i> to <i>nutarnu-</i> , together with the complete bound L–N volume. Christel Rüster and Erich Neu, <i>Hethitisches Zeichenlexikon. Inventar und Interpretationen der Keilschriftzeichen aus den Boğazköy-Texten (HZL)</i> , first edition.
1990	HEG , Lieferungen 5–6, covering L–M.

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1991	HW², Band III/1, H/ḥa to ḥaz, begins with Lieferung 11. HED, vol. 3: <i>Words beginning with Ḥ</i>. HEG, Lieferung 7, N, and Lieferung 8, the first part of the T/D section. Friedrich, <i>Kurzgefasstes Hethitisches Wörterbuch (KHW)</i>, an unchanged reprint combining the original HW and its three <i>Ergänzungshefte</i>. Rüster and Neu, <i>Deutsch-Sumerographisches Wörterverzeichnis</i>, a supplementary index to the HZL.
1993	HEG, Lieferung 9, the second part of the T/D section. Rüster and Neu, <i>Konträrindex der hethitischen Keilschriftzeichen</i>, a further supplementary index to the HZL.
1994	CHD, P, fascicle 1: <i>pa-</i> to <i>para</i>. HEG, Lieferung 10, completing the T/D section. Jin Jie, <i>A Complete Retrograde Glossary of the Hittite Language (CRGH)</i>.
1995	CHD, P, fascicle 2: <i>para-</i> to <i>pattar</i>.
1997	CHD, P, fascicle 3: <i>pattar</i> to <i>putkiya-</i>, together with the complete bound P volume.
2001	HED, vol. 4: <i>Words beginning with K</i>. HED, vol. 5: <i>Words beginning with L. Indices to Volumes 1–5</i>. HEG, Lieferungen 11–12, P. Johann Tischler, <i>Hethitisches Handwörterbuch. Mit dem Wortschatz der Nachbarsprachen (HHw)</i>, first edition.
2002	CHD, S, fascicle 1: <i>sa-</i> to <i>saptamenzu</i>.
2004	HED, vol. 6: <i>Words beginning with M</i>. HEG, Lieferung 13, S/1. The <i>Electronic Chicago Hittite Dictionary (eCHD)</i> is officially introduced. The first volume converted into electronic form is P.
2005	CHD, S, fascicle 2: <i>saptamenzu</i> to <i>-ši-</i>.
2006	HEG, Lieferung 14, S/2.

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2007	HW², Band III/1, 𐎶/𐎶a to 𐎶az, Lieferungen 11–17, completed. HED, vol. 7: <i>Words beginning with N</i>. Ahmet Ünal, <i>Multilinguales Handwörterbuch des Hethitischen / A Concise Multilingual Hittite Dictionary / Hititçe Çok Dilli El Sözlüğü (CMHD)</i>, two volumes.
2008	Alwin Kloekhorst, <i>Etymological Dictionary of the Hittite Inherited Lexicon (EDHIL)</i>. Tischler, <i>Hethitisches Handwörterbuch. Mit dem Wortschatz der Nachbarsprachen</i>, second, enlarged and revised edition.
2010	HW², Band III/2, 𐎶/𐎶e to 𐎶u, Lieferungen 18–21, begins.
	HEG, Lieferung 15, U.
2011	HED, vol. 8: <i>Words beginning with PA</i>. Rüster and Neu, <i>Hethitisches Zeichenlexikon</i>, second, unchanged edition. Rukiye Akdoğan and Oğuz Soysal, <i>Boğazköy Tablets in the Archaeological Museum of Ankara II (CHDS 1)</i>. Mark Weeden, <i>Hittite Logograms and Hittite Scholarship (HLHS)</i>.
2013	HW², Band III/2, 𐎶/𐎶e to 𐎶u, Lieferungen 18–21, completed. CHD, S, fascicle 3: <i>se-</i> to <i>šizišalla-</i>.
	HED, vol. 9: <i>Words beginning with PE, PI, PU</i>.
2014	HW², Band IV, I, Lieferungen 22–25, begins. The first stage of <i>eDiAna: Digital Philological-Etymological Dictionary of the Minor Ancient Anatolian Corpus Languages</i> begins in November 2014.
2015	Oğuz Soysal, <i>Unpublished Bo-Fragments in Transliteration I: Bo 9536–Bo 9736 (CHDS 2)</i>.
2016	HEG, Lieferung 16, W–Z. The dictionary is completed. Johann Tischler and Sylvie Vanséveren, <i>Vocabulaire hittite, y compris louvite, palaïte, akkadien et sumérien</i>.

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2017	HW² , Band IV, I, Lieferungen 22–25, completed.
	HW² , Band V, K, Lieferung 26.
2018	HED , vol. 10: <i>Words beginning with SA</i> .
	The second stage of the eDiAna project begins in October 2018.
2019	CHD , S, fascicle 4: <i>-šma/i- A. to šūu-</i> , together with the complete bound S volume.
	Oğuz Soysal and Başak Yıldız Gülşen, <i>Unpublished Bo-Fragments in Transliteration II: Bo 6151–Bo 9535 (CHDS 3)</i> .
2020	The LAMAN database of Hittite personal, divine, and geographical names is initiated by Michele Cammarosano.
	HW² , Band V, K, Lieferung 27.
2021	HW² , Band V, K, Lieferung 28.
	HW² , Band V, K, Lieferung 29, bearing the title-page date 2021.
2022	HED , vol. 11: <i>Words beginning with SE, SI, SU. Indices to Volumes 6–11.</i>
	HW² , Band V, K, Lieferung 29, appears in print.
2023	M. Ali Akman becomes co-manager of the LAMAN database.
	The open-access corpus <i>Thesaurus Linguarum Het-haeorum digitalis (TLH^{dig})</i> is released in Beta Version 0.1.
2024	Oğuz Soysal, <i>Unpublished Bo-Fragments in Transliteration III: Bo 6087–Bo 6434 (CHDS 4)</i> .
2025	TLH^{dig} , Beta Version 0.2, released on 17 March 2025.
	The first downloadable XML dataset, version 0.2.0-beta, is deposited on Zenodo in May 2025.
	Oğuz Soysal and İsmet Aykut, <i>Unpublished Bo-Fragments in Transliteration IV: Bo 2689–Bo 5660 (CHDS 5)</i> .
	TLH^{dig} , Beta Version 0.3, released on 1 November 2025.

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2026	Oğuz Soysal and Mine Çifçi, <i>Unpublished Bo-Fragments in Transliteration V: Bo 1398–Bo 6002</i> (CHDS 6), published on 29 April 2026. Adam Kryszewski joins the management and research team of LAMAN. HW², Lieferungen 30–32, intended to complete Band V, K, remain in preparation. The CHD T volume remains in active preparation and has not yet been published.
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